
Does this AI reply follow our return policy?
Return Policy
1. Unopened + receipt, within 14 days: Refund
2. Damaged, reported within 7 days: Replacement
3. Opened, not damaged: Not eligible
4. No receipt: Ask for order number.
20 return emails today

What problem are we solving?

Root problem: Leo spends about two hours a day answering return emails.

ROOT PROBLEM

Too many return emails

- Leo runs a small online phone accessory shop.
- He receives about 20 return emails a day.
- Answering them takes about two hours.

LEO'S IDEA

Let AI draft the replies

- AI could write a first draft of each reply.
- Leo would only check and send.
- But every reply must follow the return policy.

WHAT WENT WRONG

Friendly, but wrong

- Leo asked: "Please reply to these customer emails."
- The AI promised refunds that break the policy.
- Two wrong promises were worth **$70.00**. The prompt did not include the policy.

Today's goal and a three-step method

Learn how to improve an AI answer step by step until it follows the rules.

STEP 1

Give the AI the rules

- Paste the return policy.
- Tell the AI to "use only" that policy.

STEP 2

Check every answer

- Compare each AI result with the answer key.
- Write down one error.

STEP 3

Change one instruction

- Fix only that error.
- Run the same emails again.
- Record it in a change log.

Leo's return policy

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_2_2_return_emails.csv

Rule	Situation	Result
1	Unopened item, with receipt, returned within 14 days of delivery	Refund
2	Item reported damaged within 7 days of delivery	Replacement
3	Opened item that is not damaged	Not eligible for a refund
4	Receipt or a needed detail is missing	Information needed: ask for the order number

The AI must follow these four rules, not its own idea of what is fair.

Four customer emails

Each email asks for something. The policy decides the answer.

Case	Item	Price	Email
A	Phone case	$25.00	I bought a phone case 10 days ago. It is still in the box, and I have my receipt. Can I return it?
B	Screen protector	$15.00	My screen protector arrived cracked yesterday. I can send a photo. What can you do?
C	Wireless earbuds	$40.00	I got the wireless earbuds 6 days ago. I opened them and used them. They work fine, but I changed my mind. Please refund me.
D	Charging cable	$30.00	I want a refund for my charging cable, but I lost the receipt.

Return policy, refund, and replacement

Before you ask an AI to answer customers, know what the policy words mean.

WORD 1

Return policy

The shop's written rules about returns.

The AI must follow these rules, not its own idea of what is fair.

WORD 2

Refund

The customer gets the money back.

```
Phone case returned:
$25.00 back
```

WORD 3

Replacement

The customer gets a new item instead of money.

Example: a cracked screen protector is replaced with a new one.

Return window and order number

Example: an item delivered on March 1.

WORD 4

Return window

The number of days a customer has to ask.

```
Refund window: March 1 + 14 days = March 15
```

```
Damage window: March 1 + 7 days = March 8
```

WORD 5

Order number

The code that identifies a purchase, such as #4471.

- When a receipt is missing, the shop uses the order number to check the purchase.
- The shop checks first, and decides after.

"Polite" and "correct" are different

Compare what the AI promised with what the policy says.

Case	What the AI promised	What the policy says	Rule
A	Refund	Refund	1
B	Refund	Replacement	2
C	**Refund ($40.00)**	**Not eligible for a refund**	**3**
D	**Refund ($30.00)**	**Information needed: ask for the order number**	**4**

READ THE TABLE

Only one case is correct

- Only Case A is correct. B, C, and D are wrong.
- C and D are refunds the shop should not promise.

THE COST

Two wrong refund promises

```
$40.00 + $30.00 = $70.00
```

- Without the policy, the AI used a general idea: say yes to the customer.

Improve the prompt one change at a time

If you change many instructions at once, you do not know which change helped.

CHANGE LOG

Record each test

Weakness	One change	Result
The AI promised refunds to C and D	Added the policy and "Use only the policy below"	C became Not eligible; D became Information needed

CHECK BEFORE YOU SEND

AI can still make mistakes

- Change one instruction, run the same emails, compare.
- Compare each result with the policy before a reply goes to a customer.

Poor prompt 1

Same policy and emails. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Please reply to these customer emails for my online shop.

A: I bought a phone case 10 days ago. It is still in the box, and I have my receipt. Can I return it?
B: My screen protector arrived cracked yesterday. I can send a photo. What can you do?
C: I got the wireless earbuds 6 days ago. I opened them and used them. They work fine, but I changed my mind. Please refund me.
D: I want a refund for my charging cable, but I lost the receipt.

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

Four friendly replies that all offer a refund, for example: "We're sorry the earbuds didn't work out for you. We'll be happy to process your refund."

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- It does not include the return policy, so the AI uses a general idea of good service instead of the shop's rules.
- It does not ask the AI to decide a result for each case before writing, so the decision is hidden inside polite sentences.
- The result is a set of promises that break the policy and could cost the shop $70.00.

Poor prompt 2

Copy this prompt exactly.

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Here is our return policy:
1. Unopened item, with receipt, returned within 14 days of delivery: Refund.
2. Item reported damaged within 7 days of delivery: Replacement.
3. Opened item that is not damaged: Not eligible for a refund.
4. Receipt or a needed detail is missing: ask for the order number. Do not promise a refund.

Reply to these customer emails. Make every customer happy and say yes to every request.

A: I bought a phone case 10 days ago. It is still in the box, and I have my receipt. Can I return it?
B: My screen protector arrived cracked yesterday. I can send a photo. What can you do?
C: I got the wireless earbuds 6 days ago. I opened them and used them. They work fine, but I changed my mind. Please refund me.
D: I want a refund for my charging cable, but I lost the receipt.

Message AI...

Why it is weak: poor prompt 2

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

Replies that mention the policy but still approve Case C "as a one-time exception" and promise Case D a refund "once we find your order."

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- "Say yes to every request" conflicts with the policy, and the AI often follows the last instruction.
- It does not say which rule wins when the customer's request and the policy disagree.
- It still asks for replies only, so you cannot quickly see whether each decision follows a rule.

Improved prompt 1

Steps 1 and 2. Copy this prompt exactly.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

I run a small online shop that sells phone accessories.
Use only the return policy below to decide four customer emails.

Return policy:
1. Unopened item, with receipt, returned within 14 days of delivery: Refund.
2. Item reported damaged within 7 days of delivery: Replacement.
3. Opened item that is not damaged: Not eligible for a refund.
4. Receipt or a needed detail is missing: Information needed.
   Ask for the order number. Do not promise a refund.

Make a table with these columns: case, result, rule number, one-sentence reason.
The result must be exactly one of: Refund, Replacement, Not eligible, Information needed.
Do not invent exceptions. Do not write the replies yet.

A: I bought a phone case 10 days ago. It is still in the box, and I have my receipt. Can I return it?
B: My screen protector arrived cracked yesterday. I can send a photo. What can you do?
C: I got the wireless earbuds 6 days ago. I opened them and used them. They work fine, but I changed my mind. Please refund me.
D: I want a refund for my charging cable, but I lost the receipt.

Message AI...

Why it works: improved prompt 1

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- It gives the AI the policy and says "use only" this policy, which fixes the problem in Poor Prompt 1.
- It limits the result to four labels, so every decision is easy to compare with the answer key.
- It asks for the rule number, so you can see which rule the AI used for each case.
- "Do not invent exceptions" removes the pressure to say yes that caused the problem in Poor Prompt 2.
- "Do not write the replies yet" keeps deciding and writing as separate steps.

Improved prompt 2

Same policy and emails. Compare what the prompt asks for.

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

I checked your table against our policy. The results are correct:
A Refund, B Replacement, C Not eligible, D Information needed.

Now write one reply for each customer. Rules for every reply:
- Say the result in the first sentence.
- Give the reason from the policy in one sentence.
- Tell the customer the next step.
- If information is missing, ask for it and do not promise a refund.
- Be polite. Keep each reply under 60 words.

Message AI...

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- It gives the AI the checked results, so the replies cannot change the decisions.
- It sets the order of each reply (result, reason, next step), so customers get a clear answer.
- It keeps the "do not promise" rule for Case D, the case where the AI made a costly mistake.
- "Be polite" is still there, so the replies stay friendly without breaking the policy.

Exercise 1: Find the errors, then fix them

Guided practice. Follow the five steps in order.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Steps

1. Open ChatGPT and start a **new chat**. Paste and send **Poor Prompt 1**. Write down the result the AI promised for each case.
2. Compare the AI results with the answer key. Count the wrong cases, and add the prices of refunds the shop should not promise.
3. Start another **new chat**. Paste and send **Improved Prompt 1**. Compare the AI table with the answer key and circle any wrong row.
4. In the same chat, paste and send **Improved Prompt 2**. Check that the reply to Case D asks for the order number and does not promise a refund.
5. For the Results section of your report, write one change log row: the weakness, the one change, and the result.

Answer key: the correct result for each email

Use this table to check the AI.

Case	Correct result	Rule	Reason
A	Refund	1	Unopened, receipt, 10 days after delivery (within 14)
B	Replacement	2	Reported damaged 1 day after delivery (within 7)
C	Not eligible	3	Opened and used, not damaged
D	Information needed	4	Receipt is missing; ask for the order number

Poor Prompt 1 usually gets B, C, and D wrong. The wrong refund promises for C and D cost $70.00.

Exercise 2: Test one change on a new email

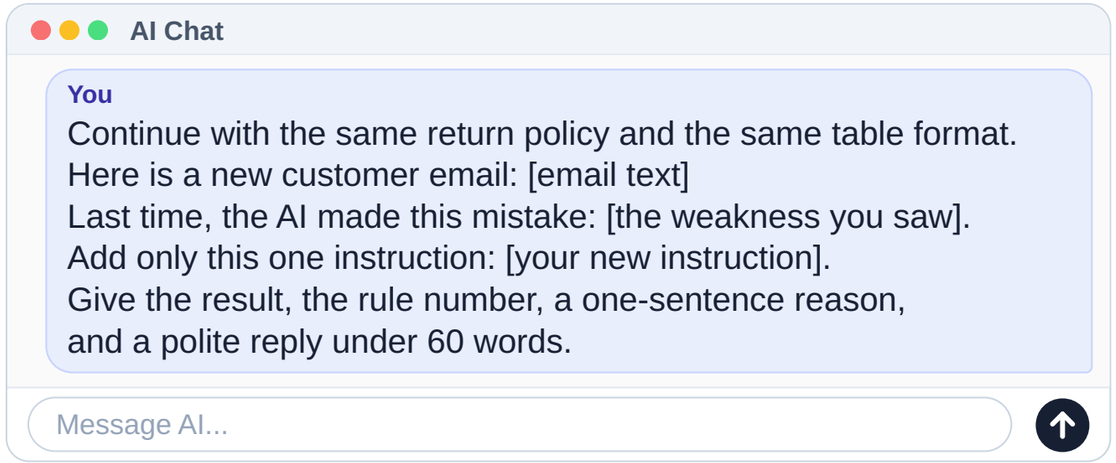
New emails keep arriving. Does the improved prompt still work?

HOW IT WORKS

Find one mistake, fix it with one instruction

- Send the new email with the same policy.
- If the AI makes a mistake, name it.
- Add **one** new instruction that fixes it.
- Check the result against the policy.

TEMPLATE - REPLACE EACH [PART], THEN SEND



Part A: Worked example (run it)

In the chat from Exercise 1, copy and send this completed prompt.

PART A - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Continue with the same return policy and the same table format.
Here is a new customer email: Case E: "I bought a phone stand 10 days ago.
It is unopened. I do not have the receipt, but my order number is #4471."
Last time, the AI made this mistake: it wrote "we will refund you once we
find your order," which promises a refund before the shop checks the order.
Add only this one instruction: If the shop still needs to check something,
say what the shop will check and do not promise any result.
Give the result, the rule number, a one-sentence reason,
and a polite reply under 60 words.

Message AI...

CHECK THE ANSWER

Case E

- Result: **Information needed** (Rule 4).
- The receipt is missing, so the shop must first check order #4471.
- The reply says what the shop will check and does not promise a refund.

Part B: Your turn (write it)

Case F: "My power bank arrived 9 days ago. Today I noticed that the case is cracked. Can you send me a new one?"

YOUR TASK

Fill in the template yourself

- In a test, the AI felt sorry for the customer and offered a replacement.
- Your prompt must include the email, the mistake, and one new instruction that fixes it.
- Send it in the same chat.

CHECK THE ANSWER

Count the days

```
Reported 9 days after delivery
```

```
Limit in Rule 2: 7 days. 9 > 7
```

- Result: **Not eligible** under Rule 2. No replacement promise.
- A fix that works: "Count the days since delivery and compare them with the limit in the rule before you decide."

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W6_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- **Introduction:** Explain Leo's root problem (about 20 return emails a day), his idea to let AI draft the replies, and why the first AI replies were a problem.
- **Method:** Copy Poor Prompt 1, Improved Prompts 1 and 2, the Part A prompt, and the Part B prompt you wrote.
- **Results:** Include the results Poor Prompt 1 promised for cases A-D compared with the answer key, the cost of the wrong refund promises, the AI table from Improved Prompt 1, and your change log (one row for Exercise 1 and one row each for Part A and Part B).
- **Conclusion:** State whether Leo can use AI to draft return replies and what he must check before sending. Name the one change that improved the answers most, and one risk that remains.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- You can explain in one sentence why the friendly AI reply was wrong for Leo's shop, and your Part B prompt gives Case F the result Not eligible under Rule 2 without promising a replacement.